

UPSTRIDE RESOURCES

FREE PRACTICAL DIGITAL GROWTH SERIES

Digital Operations Playbook

Connect people, processes, data, and tools into a scalable operating system.

A practical guide to service design, SOPs, ownership, tooling, visibility, and continuous improvement.

STRATEGY > SYSTEM > SCALE

YOUR NEXT STEP FORWARD

How to use this playbook

A practical guide to service design, SOPs, ownership, tooling, visibility, and continuous improvement.

**READ**

Understand the operating model.

**ASSESS**

Score your current state honestly.

**BUILD**

Complete one focused pilot.

**REVIEW**

Use evidence to improve the system.

A note on responsible use

This free publication is for educational and planning purposes. Adapt every recommendation to your business, customers, contracts, privacy obligations, security requirements, and local laws. It is not legal, financial, accounting, cybersecurity, or regulatory advice. Product and platform capabilities change; verify current requirements before implementation.



BASELINE

Where are you now?

Rate each statement from 1 (not true yet) to 5 (consistently true). Use the lowest scores to choose your first improvement.

01 We have a shared definition of success for align.

☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

02 The current workflow and ownership are documented and understood.

☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

03 Our tools and data have clear sources of truth.

☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

04 Important exceptions are identified and assigned to a person.

☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

05 We measure outcomes, quality, and adoption - not only activity.

☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

06 The team reviews and improves the system on a regular cadence.

☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

YOUR BASELINE SCORE

6-14 START | 15-23 STABILIZE | 24-30 SCALE



THE UPSTRIDE FRAMEWORK

Five moves that build momentum

Use this sequence to move from a scattered effort to a visible, repeatable system.

01**ALIGN**

Set the direction and desired outcome.

02**MAP**

Remove ambiguity and unnecessary friction.

03**STANDARDIZE**

Create the core workflow and supporting assets.

04**ENABLE**

Launch with ownership, controls, and visibility.

05**IMPROVE**

Learn from evidence and strengthen the system.

ALIGN IN PRACTICE

Align on outcomes

Operations should translate strategy into clear services, decisions, and customer promises.

OPERATING PRINCIPLE

Make the next right action obvious, owned, and measurable.

Three actions to take

1

Define the outcomes each function owns

Define the outcomes each function owns.

2

Make service levels explicit

Make service levels explicit.

3

Identify cross-team dependencies

Identify cross-team dependencies.

DECISION PROMPT

What would become easier for the customer or the team if this part of the system worked reliably every time?

MAP IN PRACTICE

Map value and friction

Follow work across departments and systems to expose delays, rework, and hidden queues.

OPERATING PRINCIPLE

Make the next right action obvious, owned, and measurable.

Three actions to take

1

Map the customer and operator journey together

Map the customer and operator journey together.

2

Measure wait time as well as work time

Measure wait time as well as work time.

3

Mark unclear decisions and ownership

Mark unclear decisions and ownership.

DECISION PROMPT

What would become easier for the customer or the team if this part of the system worked reliably every time?

STANDARDIZE IN PRACTICE

Standardize critical work

SOPs should make good work easier while leaving room for expert judgment.

OPERATING PRINCIPLE

Make the next right action obvious, owned, and measurable.

Three actions to take

1

Document purpose, trigger, owner, and result

Document purpose, trigger, owner, and result.

2

Use checklists for high-risk moments

Use checklists for high-risk moments.

3

Keep procedures close to the work

Keep procedures close to the work.

DECISION PROMPT

What would become easier for the customer or the team if this part of the system worked reliably every time?

ENABLE IN PRACTICE

Enable with the right tools

Choose tools based on operating needs, integration, governance, and adoption.

OPERATING PRINCIPLE

Make the next right action obvious, owned, and measurable.

Three actions to take

1

Reduce overlapping systems

Reduce overlapping systems.

2

Define system-of-record boundaries

Define system-of-record boundaries.

3

Train around workflows, not features

Train around workflows, not features.

DECISION PROMPT

What would become easier for the customer or the team if this part of the system worked reliably every time?

IMPROVE IN PRACTICE

Build an improvement rhythm

Teams need regular signals, reviews, and experiments to keep operations healthy.

OPERATING PRINCIPLE

Make the next right action obvious, owned, and measurable.

Three actions to take

1

Use a small operational scorecard

Use a small operational scorecard.

2

Review exceptions and root causes

Review exceptions and root causes.

3

Assign owners and dates to improvements

Assign owners and dates to improvements.

DECISION PROMPT

What would become easier for the customer or the team if this part of the system worked reliably every time?



MOVE FROM IDEA TO PILOT

A focused implementation sprint

Keep the first implementation narrow enough to learn quickly and important enough to matter.

1

Define services and outcomes

DAYS 1-3

2

Map one cross-team workflow

DAYS 4-7

3

Identify top friction points

DAYS 8-11

4

Update SOPs and ownership

DAYS 12-16

5

Simplify tool handoffs

DAYS 17-21

6

Launch an operations scorecard

DAYS 22-26

7

Run the first improvement review

DAYS 27-30



MAKE IT CONCRETE

One-page system brief

Complete this before selecting tools or building assets. Short, specific answers are more useful than broad ambition.

01 SERVICE AND CUSTOMER OUTCOME

02 WORKFLOW TRIGGER AND FINISH

03 OWNERS AND HANDOFFS

04 SYSTEMS OF RECORD

05 SERVICE LEVEL AND EXCEPTIONS

06 IMPROVEMENT REVIEW CADENCE



EVIDENCE OVER ACTIVITY

A practical scorecard

Choose a small set of measures that show customer value, operational quality, and sustainable adoption.

MEASURE	BASELINE	TARGET	CADENCE
End-to-end cycle time			
On-time completion			
Rework rate			
SLA attainment			
Tool adoption			

REVIEW QUESTION

What changed, why did it change, and what will we do next?



READY TO MOVE FORWARD?

Final readiness check

A healthy launch has clarity, ownership, safeguards, measurement, and a defined next review.

- ☐ The desired business and customer outcome is specific.
- ☐ A named owner is accountable for the system.
- ☐ The normal workflow and important exceptions are documented.
- ☐ Data access, privacy, and security requirements are reviewed.
- ☐ Users have been trained in the real workflow.
- ☐ Success measures have baselines, targets, and owners.
- ☐ A rollback or recovery path exists where needed.
- ☐ The first improvement review is scheduled.

YOUR NEXT STEP FORWARD

Continue with Digital Business Operations Specialist.

See the guided learning path: upstride-three.vercel.app/academy/digital-business-operations

FREE GUIDE TO GUIDED PRACTICE

Ready to build the skill?

This playbook gives you the framework. The matching Upstride Academy program helps you apply it through structured lessons, practical projects, downloadable tools, and a capstone.

RECOMMENDED PROGRAM

Digital Business Operations Specialist

UPSTRIDE ACADEMY | PRACTICAL, PROJECT-BASED LEARNING

What the program helps you do

1

Connect people, processes, data, and tools

Connect people, processes, data, and tools through guided exercises and feedback-ready project work.

2

Create useful SOPs and operating scorecards

Create useful SOPs and operating scorecards through guided exercises and feedback-ready project work.

3

Deliver an end-to-end operations improvement plan

Deliver an end-to-end operations improvement plan through guided exercises and feedback-ready project work.

CHOOSE YOUR SUPPORT LEVEL

Basic | Pro | Mentored

Review current package details and availability on the course page before enrolling.

View the program and enroll

upstride-three.vercel.academy/digital-business-operations